

Jasmine Flower

A:1

Arranged by Peter Batchelar

Trad. Chinese

Gently ♩ = c.80

The musical score is written for a single melodic line in 4/4 time. It begins with a treble clef and a key signature of one sharp (F#). The tempo is marked 'Gently' with a quarter note equal to approximately 80 beats per minute. The first staff contains measures 1 through 4, starting with a forte (f) dynamic and a mezzo-forte (mf) dynamic. The second staff contains measures 5 through 8, continuing the melody with a mezzo-forte (mf) dynamic. The third staff contains measures 9 through 12, featuring triplets and a 'poco rit.' (poco ritardando) marking. The score ends with a double bar line.

'Jasmine Flower' is a popular Chinese folk song, often performed on major public occasions such as the 2008 Beijing Olympic Games. The words praise the fragile beauty of the flower. The melody, in the typically Chinese pentatonic (five-note) scale, was first printed in a Western book in 1804. It was reproduced on a mechanical musical box brought back from China around 1900 by the Italian aristocrat Baron Fassini. Having heard the tune played on this musical box, Giacomo Puccini used it extensively in his last opera, *Turandot* (1926), which is set in Beijing.